

EVERFI — Company Stability Research

Prepared July 7, 2026 · Context: evaluating EVERFI ahead of a possible software engineer interview

What EVERFI Is

EVERFI is an education technology company providing online courses and training, delivered through schools and workplaces rather than sold to individuals. Its main lines: K-12/college courses (financial literacy, AlcoholEdu, prevention training), workplace compliance training (harassment prevention, data privacy), and bank-sponsored financial education programs delivered in schools. Founded 2008, headquartered in Washington, D.C.

Bottom Line

EVERFI's recent track record is rocky — it is a turnaround situation under new private-equity ownership, not a stable incumbent. Not necessarily a bad move for a candidate, but one to enter with eyes open.

Timeline

- **2021:** Sold its higher-ed division to Vector Solutions (~\$100M); Blackbaud then acquired the rest for about **\$750M**.
- **2021–2024:** The Blackbaud era went badly. Glassdoor reviews describe multiple rounds of layoffs, benefit cuts (reduced PTO, more expensive health plans, worse 401k), and stalled product development while the company was "polished" for sale.
- **Dec 31, 2024:** Blackbaud sold EVERFI to an **undisclosed private investment firm for a "nominal amount"** — effectively writing the \$750M purchase down to zero.
- **2025–2026:** Signs of a rebuild. Co-founder Ray Martinez is back as CEO; in January 2026 the company hired a new COO (ex-Pearson/Scholastic) and a VP of Finance, with messaging about "financial discipline" and "disciplined growth."

Biggest red flag: the December 2024 sale for a nominal amount, to a buyer whose identity has not been made public. The owner's capitalization and patience cannot be independently assessed.

Assessment for a Software Engineer Candidate

The business has real revenue and entrenched distribution (schools, employer compliance training, bank-sponsored programs), but it is PE-owned after a distressed sale. Cost discipline is explicitly the theme, which can mean lean teams and layoff risk if the turnaround stalls. On the upside, hiring senior

leadership and engineers signals the new owner is investing rather than just harvesting, and engineers hired *into* a rebuild are usually safer than those who survived the cuts.

Questions to Ask in the Interview

- Who owns the company now, and what is their investment horizon?
- Is the company profitable, or on a defined path to it? What is the runway?
- How has engineering headcount changed over the last two years — is the team growing?
- How much engineering time goes to new product work versus maintenance?

Vague or defensive answers are themselves a signal. A strong offer from a turnaround can be a good deal, but weigh it against more stable alternatives if available.

Sources

- [Blackbaud sale announcement](#)
- [PrivSource deal summary](#)
- [Yahoo Finance on the divestiture](#)
- [EVERFI leadership press release, Jan 2026](#)
- [Glassdoor layoff reviews](#)